Hills in October 1966. They trekked for months through the jungles of northern Myanmar and, in January 1967, reached Yunnan, China, where they received political and military training. The first batch of Nagas returned to India at the end of 1967 with modern Chinese-made assault rifles, machine guns, and rocket launchers. During the decade 1967–76, more than 700 Naga rebels went to China for training and returned, heavily armed, to fight the Indian Army. After the Nagas, Mizo rebels, also from the eastern border mountains, trekked to China, where they too received military training and went back to their hills with Chinese weapons. In the 1970s, a group of rebels from Manipur received political and military training by the Chinese in Tibet.

Before the 1962 War, the PLA had gained some useful experience in launching a decisive assault into a neighbouring country. From November 1960 to February 1961, thousands of Chinese troops crossed the border into Myanmar to attack nationalist Chinese Kuomintang (KMT) forces, which, after their defeat in the Chinese Civil War that ended in 1949, had retreated into the remote, northeastern mountains of that country. From those cross-border sanctuaries, they had carried out raids into China. That operation, codenamed the Mekong River Operation in Myanmar, and the Burma [Myanmar] Border Surveying and Security Operation in China, was carried out in co-operation with the Myanmar Army, which also wanted to get rid of the intruders.

But the campaign was only partly successful. Most of the KMT troops managed to escape the onslaught and retreat down to the Thai border, while the PLA's weaknesses were exposed, as they had to fight in an unfamiliar terrain and environment. Although the units that took part in the operation were not the same as those that attacked India in 1962, it is reasonable to assume that China's military strategists learned from their mistakes and, therefore, a year later were able to conduct a more victorious campaign in the Himalayas.[19]

But then, what about the Henderson Brooks–Bhagat Report? It remains classified but I managed to get a copy of it in 2013, passed on to me by a senior Indian journalist. A year later, Maxwell decided to make it public. He posted a copy of the report as a PDF file on the internet, and the Hong Kong daily *South China Morning Post* reported on it under the headline, 'Neville Maxwell discloses document revealing that India provoked China into 1962 border war'. The article went on to make the astonishing